

# A balancing-selected chromosome-2 supergene and a neural–photoreceptive program of recent selection in the northern shortfin squid *Illex illecebrosus*

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## Abstract

Highly dispersive marine species can show little geographic population structure while harbouring substantial adaptive genomic variation. Here we use a chromosome-level reference genome and whole-genome data from 633 northern shortfin squid, *Illex illecebrosus*, sampled across the Northwest Atlantic to resolve genomic variation that was previously inaccessible using a divergent reference assembly. We confirm essentially complete range-wide panmixia, but identify a single major axis of genomic structure: a ~19 Mb inversion on chromosome 2. The derived arrangement segregates at a frequency of 0.374, occurs throughout the species’ range without a geographic cline, and reaches  $F_{ST} = 0.37$  between alternative homozygotes despite geographic  $F_{ST} \approx 0$ . Its evolutionary history is inconsistent with neutral drift. The rarer derived arrangement retains 2.3-fold more diversity than expected from its present frequency, and barrier-aware coalescent modelling dates the polymorphism to ~850 ka, reconstructing a prolonged period near frequency  $p \approx 0.74$  followed by an active decline over the last ~50–100 ky. The inversion is gene-poor and lacks functional enrichment, but contains thousands of near-fixed differences concentrated across the non-recombining block, supporting selection on the arrangement as a long-lived supergene rather than on a single locally adaptive locus.

Outside the inversion, demographic analyses support strong expansion (Tajima’s  $D = -1.5$ ) and an effective population size exceeding 4 million. A stratified, cross-method-corroborated scan for recent positive selection identified 662 candidate sweep windows, including 34 high-confidence regions independently supported by multiple methods. Sweep-associated genes show strong and background-selection-robust enrichment for two biological themes: neurodevelopment and photoreception, with additional candidates involving lineage-specific genes and Z-linked RNA-regulatory and hormone-signalling loci. Together, these results reveal two contrasting modes of adaptation in an otherwise panmictic marine species: a long-lived chromosomal polymorphism maintained by balancing selection and recent directional selection on sensory and neural functions. More broadly, they demonstrate how a conspecific reference genome can expose structural and adaptive variation that is largely invisible to geographic differentiation alone.

## 1 Introduction

Marine populations with enormous census sizes and high dispersal present a persistent problem for population genetics: weak geographic differentiation can coexist with substantial evolutionarily important variation that is invisible to conventional population-structure analyses. This problem is

especially acute in pelagic cephalopods. Ommastrephid squids are short-lived, semelparous, highly fecund, and capable of extensive dispersal during both early life and adulthood, producing large and often highly variable populations whose abundance is closely coupled to oceanographic conditions (??). The northern shortfin squid *Illex illecebrosus* exemplifies this life history. It is an annual, semelparous broadcast spawner distributed across more than 2,500 km of the Northwest Atlantic shelf and slope, from the Mid-Atlantic Bight to Newfoundland and Labrador, where it supports major commercial fisheries in both U.S. and Canadian waters (???). Recruitment and distribution are strongly influenced by transport in the Gulf Stream and associated shelf-slope circulation, while adults undertake extensive horizontal and diel vertical migrations. Together, high dispersal, extreme fecundity, and large population size predict little persistent geographic structure even while providing abundant substrate for natural selection.

These same characteristics complicate genomic inference. The fecundity-with-high-mortality demography of *Illex illecebrosus* is the profile that motivates sweepstakes-reproductive-success models, in which a small and variable fraction of adults contributes disproportionately to each generation (???). Large effective population size can simultaneously increase the efficacy of weak selection, preserve abundant standing variation, and generate very short linkage disequilibrium, making population history and recent selection difficult to disentangle. More generally, genomic analysis of cephalopods has lagged behind that of many commercially important vertebrates because their genomes are large, repeat rich, and extensively reorganised relative to other molluscs (?????). Until recently, these limitations were particularly severe for *Illex illecebrosus*, for which no conspecific chromosome-level reference genome was available.

The first range-wide population-genomic analysis of *Illex illecebrosus* provided a critical baseline. Using whole-genome data from 540 specimens collected across more than 40 sites, ? found essentially no geographic genetic structure across the species’ Northwest Atlantic range, consistent with extensive connectivity mediated by early-life dispersal and adult migration. That study consequently supported treatment of *Illex illecebrosus* as a single, highly connected stock. However, in the absence of a conspecific assembly, reads were mapped to the chromosome-level genome of the distantly related diamondback squid *Thysanoteuthis rhombus*, approximately 51 million years divergent, with a mean alignment rate of only ~46 to the fraction of the genome sufficiently conserved to map reliably and reduces power in precisely the regions most likely to contain lineage-specific sequence, structural polymorphism, and rapidly evolving loci. Baker et al. therefore found no evidence of large structural variants, but explicitly identified reference divergence as a limitation on their ability to detect them.

Chromosomal inversions are particularly susceptible to this problem because their evolutionary importance derives not simply from their breakpoints but from the long haplotypes they maintain. Inversions suppress recombination between alternative arrangements and can thereby preserve combinations of alleles as segregating “supergenes” (?????). Many of the best-characterised examples have conspicuous phenotypic effects or occur in spatially structured populations, including mimicry in *Heliconius* (?), alternative reproductive morphs in the ruff (?), colony organisation in fire ants (?), and life-history variation in *Mimulus* (?). Correspondingly, much inversion theory has focused on local adaptation with migration, where suppressed recombination protects locally favoured combinations of alleles from gene flow (??). Inversions maintained at intermediate frequency *without* geographic structure pose a different problem. Their persistence instead implies balancing processes such as overdominance, associative overdominance generated by recessive deleterious load (???), negative frequency dependence, or temporally fluctuating selection (??). Distinguishing these histories from neutral drift requires reconstructing the age and frequency history of the arrangements while accounting explicitly for the recombination barrier between them (???).

A chromosome-level *Illex illecebrosus* genome also creates an opportunity to ask where selection

has acted outside large structural polymorphisms. Cephalopods provide an unusual setting for this question because extreme life history is coupled to exceptional sensory and neural complexity. Coleoid genomes exhibit substantial lineage-specific reorganisation (?), extensive RNA-editing-based transcriptomic plasticity (?), and elaborate nervous and visual systems (????). In squids, vision operates across large changes in depth and illumination during diel vertical migration, and photoreception extends beyond the camera eye to dermal opsins and light-responsive chromatophore systems (???). In a large, highly connected population where geographic  $F_{ST}$  provides little leverage for detecting adaptation, recent positive selection should instead be evident primarily through local distortions of diversity, linkage disequilibrium, and the site-frequency spectrum. Correctly interpreting those signals, however, requires first establishing the demographic and genealogical background against which they arose.

Here we use a chromosome-level, annotated reference genome for *Illex illecebrosus* recently made available in ? to reanalyse range-wide whole-genome variation at substantially greater genomic resolution. Our dataset comprises 633 individuals spanning eleven fishery-management divisions (?), together with *I. coindetii* (?) as an outgroup for divergence-based inference and *I. argentinus* as a recently diverged congener (?). We first test whether the range-wide panmixia reported by ? persists when reads are mapped to a conspecific reference and ask whether previously inaccessible structural variation becomes apparent. This reveals a single ~19 Mb inversion on chromosome 2 that segregates across the range despite an otherwise essentially unstructured genome. We then ask whether this inversion is a neutral polymorphism or a selected supergene by combining arrangement-specific diversity and divergence with a barrier-aware coalescent model that reconstructs its age and historical frequency trajectory. In parallel, we infer population history from the site-frequency spectrum and linkage disequilibrium, explicitly evaluate whether the data require a multiple-merger rather than Kingman coalescent, and scan the remaining genome for recent positive selection using complementary methods (??). These analyses resolve two distinct forms of genomic adaptation in an otherwise panmictic species: a long-lived, balancing-selected chromosomal polymorphism and a genome-wide set of recent sweeps concentrated in neurodevelopmental and photoreceptive functions. Together, they show how a conspecific genome transforms the apparent genomic landscape of a highly connected marine species, revealing structural and adaptive variation that is largely invisible to geographic differentiation alone.

## 2 Results

### 2.1 Sample, sex, and the absence of geographic structure

We analysed 633 *Illex illecebrosus* individuals from eleven NAFO management divisions spanning ~37–50°N (??, ??). Read coverage on the Z chromosome separates the sample into 342 ZZ males and 291 ZO females, consistent with a ZZ/ZO system (?) (??); Autosomal analyses use both sexes; the Z, on which males are diploid and females haploid, is analysed separately (??).

Consistent with the range-wide panmixia reported by ?, population structure exists in exactly one place in the genome, and that place is not geographic. A windowed principal-component analysis along chromosome 2 localises the three-cluster structure to the inversion (among-cluster variance  $\eta^2 = 0.748$  inside it against  $\eta^2 = 0.003$  in collinear sequence; Supplementary Fig. S3), and two genome-wide tests show it is unique. First, the chromosome-2 karyotype explains none of the variation on any other chromosome (per-chromosome PCA coloured by karyotype:  $\eta^2 = 0.76$  on chr2 versus  $\leq 0.01$  on all 45 others). Second, and independently of the chr2 labels, a Gaussian-mixture screen of each chromosome’s leading principal component supports more than one cluster only on chromosome 2 (three clusters,  $\Delta BIC = 199$ , cluster separation  $8.6\sigma$ ) and on

the Z (two clusters — the expected ZZ/ZO hemizyosity split); every autosome is a single cloud (??). The residual dispersion on minor PCA axes tracks neither division, latitude, nor coverage (Supplementary Fig. S1), and a KING-robust relatedness screen (?) finds no duplicate, parent-offspring, or full-sib pairs and a single second-degree pair among the 633 individuals (maximum kinship 0.16), effectively unrelated. Because a per-SNP differentiation scan is the most sensitive test for local adaptation in a population this panmictic, we compared per-SNP  $F_{ST}$  among divisions to a coalescent neutral null — a single panmictic population simulated under the fitted demography at the empirical sample sizes and missingness. Across the full callsets (551,344 SNPs in 12,007 genes) the empirical differentiation lies entirely within the drift expectation: no SNP exceeds the neutral maximum, a single intergenic site passes the lenient threshold against  $\approx 556$  expected by chance, and there are zero genic outliers (Supplementary Figs. S2, S19). Nucleotide diversity and Tajima’s  $D$  are flat across latitude and pairwise  $F_{ST}$  among divisions is  $\approx 0$  throughout (??). There is therefore no geographic local adaptation anywhere in the genome, and the inversion is geographically non-clinal.

## 2.2 A large, balancing-selected inversion on chromosome 2

**Identity, breakpoints, and karyotypes.** Local PCA (?) and a Gaussian-mixture karyotype assignment (95.3% confident) resolve three genotype clusters on chromosome 2 — 254 AA, 284 AB, and 95 BB individuals (??a) — whose differentiation is karyotypic, not geographic:  $F_{ST}(AA, BB) = 0.37$  inside the inversion against a geographic  $F_{ST} \approx 0$ . Between-karyotype  $F_{ST}$  computed along the whole chromosome is  $\approx 0$  (median 0.006) across collinear sequence and jumps to a median of 0.34 (maximum 0.53) inside the inverted body (Supplementary Fig. S20), so the karyotypes are one panmictic population everywhere except within the barrier. The three karyotypes co-occur throughout the range with no latitudinal cline in arrangement frequency (0.29–0.46 across divisions; ??; Supplementary Fig. S6 and Table S2). Two independent lines pin the breakpoints to **chr2:60.54–79.50 Mb** (a  $\sim 18.96$  Mb differentiated body): a step-change in arrangement differentiation and a strand flip in a whole-chromosome alignment to *I. coindetii* (Supplementary Fig. S11); an extended block of linkage disequilibrium coincides with the same interval (Supplementary Fig. S4).

**Reference genome carries derived inversion** The derived, inverted arrangement is **BB, at a present frequency of 0.374**; AA is ancestral and standard. This is the reverse of the naive polarisation from the reference allele, which is circular because the *Illex illecebrosus* reference assembly is itself in the inverted orientation (it carries BB at 86.5% of fixed-different sites). Restricting to the non-circular subset of sites at which *I. coindetii* carries the *Illex illecebrosus* alternate allele shows AA to be ancestral (63.0%) and BB derived — a single inversion event, with the reference simply assembled from an inverted individual (Supplementary Table S3).

**The inversion does not follow neutral trajectory.** The primary evidence is per-arrangement diversity (??, ??c). Inside an inversion the two arrangements behave as partially isolated demes (??), so at neutral equilibrium the diversity of each should scale with its frequency. The rare derived arrangement is instead *more* diverse than its frequency can sustain:  $\pi_I/\pi_S = 1.356 \pm 0.048$  against an equilibrium expectation of  $p/(1-p) = 0.60$  for a polymorphism held at 0.374 — a 2.3-fold excess that is the signature of an old polymorphism that was once common, not of a recent rise. Two mutation-rate-free diffusion arguments exclude neutrality. *Attainment*: reaching the inferred historical peak frequency of  $\sim 0.74$  by drift takes at minimum  $\sim 1.15$  million generations at the smallest  $N_e$  —  $1.36\times$  the entire inferred lifetime of the inversion, and up to  $17\times$  at present  $N_e$ . *Decline*: the observed fall from 0.74 to 0.374 is 6.7 standard deviations of neutral drift at the fitted

duration, and a coalescent profile of the fall duration excludes the slow, drift-compatible alternative at  $\Delta\chi^2 \gtrsim 8$ –80 (Supplementary Fig. S14). Thus the best fit model supports that the inversion was not lost due to drift alone.

**Age and frequency history of the inversion.** Estimating an inversion’s age requires a coalescent in which the two arrangements exchange ancestry only across the barrier; standard simulators do not provide this. We therefore fit the inversion’s age and frequency trajectory with **msinv** (?), an ancestral-recombination-graph simulator that enforces the cross-karyotype recombination barrier, tracks ancestral material and outputs tree sequences (??). The data constrain the *shape* of the frequency trajectory  $p(t)$  rather than any site-level mechanism, so we condition on a deterministic trajectory under within-arrangement neutrality and fit jointly to  $\pi_I/\pi_S$ ,  $d_{xy}/\pi_I$ , and the per-arrangement singleton spectrum (??b; Supplementary Figs. S5, S14). The coalescent age is  $\sim 850$  ky. It is the robustly determined quantity because it is carried by  $d_{xy}$  between arrangements, which is symmetric to the polarisation. The reconstructed history is that the inversion arose  $\sim 850$  ka, coincident with the onset of the population expansion (?); was maintained near  $p \approx 0.74$  for most of its history; and then fell sharply to 0.374 over  $\sim 50$ –100 ky, ending  $\gtrsim 50$ –100 ka, under selection of order  $N_e s \sim 10^2$ – $10^3$  ( $s \approx 1.5 \times 10^{-4}$ ). Simulated inversions of 37 kb rescaled to the 19-Mb body reproduce these statistics with length-invariance verified over a 25-fold range, and the fitted model reproduces the observed joint two-dimensional site-frequency spectrum between arrangements — near-fixed differences and off-diagonal density in the inverted body, collapse to the diagonal in collinear controls (Supplementary Fig. S5). However, with accepted caveat that every absolute age scales inversely with the mutation rate  $\mu = 3 \times 10^{-9}$ , which may contain rate uncertainty or variation.

**Characterizing the inversion.** It is not a region of locally suppressed crossing-over since recombination inside the body is at the chromosomal background rate by direct measurement (the  $\sim 19$  kb LD windows a recombination-map method reads are blind to a 19-Mb barrier; Supplementary Fig. S12), so the differentiation is a consequence of the arrangement barrier itself. It is not locally adaptive since there is no cline and geographic  $F_{ST} \approx 0$ , and the migration–selection scenario that explains most well-studied inversions (?) cannot apply. And it is not a swept region because the genome-wide scan below finds zero cross-method-concordant sweeps on chromosome 2. Although, we find that the recombination-map method is broadly elevated and the classifier over-calls across the inversion, but the two never co-localise into focal concordance, expected for a balancing-selected supergene rather than a swept locus. These were correctly filtered by the concordance requirement. Gene flux between arrangements is not detectable in mean  $d_{xy}$ , though a residual  $\sim 40\%$  depletion of near-fixed differences appears in the outermost megabase around the breakpoints. The mechanism of balancing selection, i.e., overdominance, associative overdominance, frequency dependence, or a moving optimum under fluctuating selection, is not resolved by these data. Though probable that a shelf-spawning squid whose paralarvae ride the Gulf Stream would experience temporally fluctuating selection on  $\sim 100$  ky glacial cycles, however this remains a hypothesis.

**Gene content and the architecture of arrangement divergence.** The inversion has no functionally significant enrichment, yet it carries the molecular signature of a young, recombination-suppressed supergene. It is by comparison, gene-poor with only 89 gene models, 45 with cross-species functional annotation, against a median of  $\sim 50$  annotated genes in random windows of the same size. Overall functional classes are diverse, with lipid metabolism, DNA repair, transcription and splicing, signalling, and no coherent pathway (Supplementary Table S7). A gene-ontology

test of its annotated genes against the genome returns no enriched terms at  $FDR < 0.05$ , and a permutation null shows this is not a power artefact with random gene sets of the same size produce more nominal hits than the inversion genes ( $86.6 \pm 60$  vs 69; permutation  $p = 0.51$ ). Even with a  $\sim 40$ -fold per-term enrichments, it only depends on as few as two genes (Supplementary Fig. S21). The inversion has thus captured a functionally unremarkable slice of the genome, not a selected gene set but a supergene maintained for the arrangement as a whole. What the arrangements do accumulate is divergence-as-a-unit: 3,513 near-fixed differences between AA and BB (per-arrangement  $|\Delta AF| \geq 0.9$ ) are spread across the inversion (Supplementary Fig. S5). These are overwhelmingly non-coding since coding sequence is only  $\sim 0.2\%$  of the region, but the exonic fixed differences are  $\sim 2.3$ -fold over-represented and clustered. All 19 fall in just nine genes, led by a cytochrome P450 (*CYP4X1*) and an acidic-repeat protein (four each) and including a phospholipase A2, the ciliary gene *RPGRIP1L*, and a cysteine-rich venom-like protein. The expected architecture of a balancing-selected inversion that recombines with its homologue only rarely, and the raw material from which a supergene's mutation load and eventual degeneration are built (??).

### 2.3 Demographic history show and expanding population

The age and selection estimates above depend on the population's demography and on the coalescent class being Kingman. Genome-wide, *Illex illecebrosus* shows  $\pi \approx 0.0093$  and Tajima's  $D \approx -2$  in essentially every window (??). An unambiguous, genome-wide signature of expansion (??, ??a, ??). A moments fit to the folded SFS gives growth from an ancestral  $N_e = 547,928$  to a present  $N_e = 6,808,096$  over 769,519 generations ( $\sim 12$ -fold; generations  $\approx$  years for this annual species), and this history reproduces both the observed  $\pi$  and a full-SFS Tajima's  $D = -1.92$  under forward simulation. Stairway Plot 2 and GONE2 concur on strong recent expansion to  $N_e$  in the  $1.5\text{--}1.7 \times 10^7$  range. Because sweepstakes reproduction would mimic expansion by inflating rare variants (???), we tested the coalescent class directly: the folded SFS is fit far better by a Kingman-plus-growth model than by any multiple-merger (Beta) coalescent (?) (shape deviation  $L_1 = 0.036$  vs a best- $\alpha$  0.108), and contemporary  $N_e$  estimates from the SFS and from linkage disequilibrium agree where both are inconsistent with a strong multiple-merger process. The expansion began  $\sim 770$  ka, i.e. at essentially the same time as the inversion arose, which places the supergene's origin at the start of the demographic episode that shapes the whole genome.

### 2.4 Genomic context: recombination, background selection, and protein adaptation

Three further features of the genome set the stage for the sweep scan. *Recombination*, as estimated by a deep-learning LD-based map built per sex, is  $\sim 0.21\text{--}0.24$  cM/Mb on the autosomes (sex-averaged  $\sim 0.244$ ; Supplementary Fig. S12); because the estimator reads linkage disequilibrium it recovers the sex-averaged rate and heterochiasmy is not identifiable from it (the female-only map in fact collapses to a near-constant and is uninformative). The map is flat with respect to gene content — the rate varies by only  $\sim 6\%$  between windows adjacent to exons and windows  $> 100$  kb from any exon, unchanged when  $\pi$  is held fixed (Supplementary Fig. S17a) — as a crossover rate should be. It is also compressed at chromosome scale: on chromosome 1 the rolling median spans just  $0.17\text{--}0.23$  cM/Mb, the pericentromeric flanks where  $\pi$  halves show no more than a 5% dip, and the centromere itself (a 2.5-Mb block that is 80% repeat and almost entirely masked) carries no windows (Supplementary Fig. S22). The pattern is genome-wide: across all 43 scanned autosomes the chromosome-scale rolling median varies by only 10–41% of each chromosome's median, and no chromosome shows a peak more than 25% above it. The map therefore fixes the genome-wide mean

well but resolves little broad-scale landscape, and “nearly uniform” is in part an estimator ceiling; none of the analyses below depend on fine-scale recombination variation. *Background selection* is moderate and gene-density-driven:  $\pi$  falls with local coding density ( $r = -0.31$ ; 20–30% reduction in gene-dense windows) and rises 43% between exon-adjacent and exon-distant windows, while recombination does neither (Supplementary Fig. S17) — the classical footprint of linked purifying selection (??), organised here by gene density rather than by the recombination axis. Diversity is also heterogeneous at the megabase scale: 22 blocks of  $\geq 1$  Mb on 17 chromosomes carry 2–4 $\times$  the chromosome-median  $\pi$  with less-negative Tajima’s  $D$  (e.g. chr1:24–31 Mb,  $\pi = 0.020$ ; Supplementary Fig. S22c). We tested these against every structural explanation and they fail all of them: local PCA finds no karyotype clusters (unlike the chr2 positive control), there is no heterozygosity excess, no excess-heterozygosity filtering loss, and no per-individual depth anomaly, and their allele-frequency spectrum is identical to flanking sequence — they simply carry  $\sim 2.5\times$  more SNPs. They are gene-poor (coding fraction 0.001), largely unalignable to *I. coindetii* (35% vs  $\sim 88\%$  of bases aligned) and 1.7-fold more divergent where alignable, and low-coverage *I. argentinus* reads also call  $\sim 3\times$  more variants in them. They are therefore fast-evolving, largely lineage-specific gene deserts — elevated mutation input and relaxed linked selection — not structural polymorphisms, and the chromosome-2 inversion remains the genome’s only segregating karyotype. A model-based  $B$ -map could not be fit under this regime (the classical approximation overflows where the deleterious mutation rate exceeds the selection coefficient), so local coding fraction serves as the background-selection covariate that the sweep scan controls for explicitly. *Protein adaptation* over the divergence timescale is substantial: McDonald–Kreitman tests (??) against *I. coindetii* across 20,999 genes give a genome-wide proportion of adaptive substitutions  $\alpha \approx 0.34$ –0.64, with the splicing factor *SF3B4* the single most significantly adaptive gene (Supplementary Fig. S10). Per-gene power is limited, so we treat the MK results as complementary to the recent-sweep scan, which detects a different — recent, often non-coding — timescale of selection. *I. argentinus* is a striking comparator: recently diverged (an order of magnitude fewer fixed coding differences than *I. coindetii*; Supplementary Table S3), it carries near-identical genome-wide diversity ( $\pi = 0.0092$  vs 0.0093, within 1%) — two large- $N_e$ , expansion-shaped congeners of matched standing variation.

## 2.5 A genome-wide scan for selective sweeps

We scanned for recent positive selection with diploS/HIC (??), a five-class site-frequency/diversity-based classifier (neutral, hard, soft, linked-hard, linked-soft; 1.1 Mb feature windows of eleven 100 kb sub-windows) trained on forward and coalescent simulations under the fitted growth demography (??; Supplementary Figs. S7, S8).

**The scan must be framed as an outlier detector.** Two methodological findings shape everything that follows. First, a training/scanning feature mismatch — the model was initially trained on phased-haplotype simulation features but applied to unphased genotypes — inflated linkage-based features by an order of magnitude and had to be corrected by retraining on the same unphased feature extractor used to scan; the final full-SFS model reaches 81% class accuracy (Supplementary Fig. S7). Second, and more fundamentally, even the corrected model *over-calls* sweeps on the real genome: real neutral windows (accessible,  $\geq 5$  kb from any gene) carry 3–8-fold more within-window spatial heterogeneity in  $\pi$  and  $\theta$  than the simulations, even though their marginal SFS matches ( $D \approx -2$ ). We ruled out missing-data structure and sample incompleteness as the cause; the residual is real per-sub-window diversity variation (mutation-rate variation plus background selection) that a uniform- $\theta$  coalescent does not reproduce — a concrete instance of the simulation-to-reality gap that current best-practice guidance warns against (?). We therefore use the classifier as a

**stratified empirical-outlier detector:** the sweep score ( $p_{\text{hard}} + p_{\text{soft}}$ ) is ranked within strata of callable fraction and coding density, so a window is an outlier only relative to windows of similar accessibility and gene density, and calls are corroborated by an independent LD-footprint method (RAiSD; ?) or a composite-likelihood SFS method (SweepFinder2; ??). We also show that an inherited minor-allele-frequency filter was a mistake under strong expansion (it discards the rare-variant excess that carries both the expansion and the sweep signal) and use the full spectrum on both the simulation and empirical sides.

**Two tiers of sweep calls.** We report sweeps at two levels of stringency (Supplementary Fig. S13).

**Tier 1** is the diploS/HIC hard/soft classification, spatially resolved by a recombination-aware Markov decoder — a hidden Markov model over the per-window (100 kb) classes, with neutral, linked, and sweep-centre states whose emissions are the prior-corrected class posteriors and whose dwell lengths follow the  $\sim 400$  kb sweep footprint scaled by the recombination map (Supplementary Fig. S13a). Because the genome reads as  $\sim 91\%$  linked-selected under strong expansion, the decoder’s role is spatial coherence: it retains hard/soft calls that lie in contiguous sweep centres and discards spatially isolated ones, reducing 1,758 raw calls to 717 windows (658 localised autosomal calls; 459 hard, 199 soft) and preferentially keeping the higher-outlier windows (median empirical-outlier percentile 0.98 vs 0.95 for discarded calls; Supplementary Fig. S13b). **Tier 2** is the subset independently corroborated by a footprint method: the 34 cross-method-concordant regions (a diploS/HIC-HMM outlier plus RAiSD or SweepFinder2). The two tiers agree strongly — 89% of windows at concordant loci are decoded as sweep centres versus 2.9% genome-wide (odds ratio 282,  $p < 10^{-46}$ ), and 30 of the 34 concordant regions contain a Tier-1 centre (Supplementary Fig. S13c) — so the conservative concordance set is a high-purity subset of the classifier calls, not a disjoint list. Because the decoder could not be simulation-calibrated at this genome’s recombination density (??), its dwell parameters are set from the sweep footprint and the recombination map and validated post hoc by this concordance; we treat Tier 1 as a ranked candidate set and Tier 2 as the high-confidence calls. The Z chromosome, which the footprint methods do not cover, is necessarily diploS/HIC-only; scanned separately in males (below), it contributes four further Tier-1 calls, for a genome-wide Tier-1 total of 662 (??; Supplementary Fig. S18).

**Two themes: neurodevelopment and photoreception.** The 658 autosomal Tier-1 calls overlap 894 genes (476 with GO annotation; one-third of calls fall in gene-poor, often transposon-rich windows and are excluded). A gene-ontology enrichment against the annotated-gene background (Fisher’s exact test, Benjamini–Hochberg FDR; ?) returns 124 terms at  $\text{FDR} < 0.05$  (Supplementary Fig. S15, Table S4), dominated by **neural development** — neurogenesis, generation of neurons, neuron development, neuron-projection and cell morphogenesis (1.5–1.8-fold) — together with transcriptional and RNA-regulatory control, and a weaker **light-response** signal (response to light stimulus 1.9-fold, response to radiation 1.8-fold). The enrichment is carried by the hard-sweep calls (99 terms); the disjoint soft-sweep set has none at  $\text{FDR} < 0.05$ . The decisive test is whether these themes are artefacts of background selection — gene-dense neural loci have lower diversity for reasons unrelated to sweeps. We therefore screened every Tier-1 call with the same per-region background-selection test used for the concordant set, retaining only calls whose local  $\pi$  falls below the background-selection expectation given flanking coding density. This keeps 291 of the 658 (237 hard, 54 soft), and the enrichment does not merely survive the screen — it *sharpens*. The BGS-robust set yields 152 terms at  $\text{FDR} < 0.05$ , and every leading term’s fold enrichment rises: response to light stimulus  $1.92 \rightarrow 3.12$  ( $\text{FDR } 2 \times 10^{-2} \rightarrow 1 \times 10^{-4}$ ), response to radiation  $1.75 \rightarrow 2.77$  ( $\text{FDR } 3 \times 10^{-2} \rightarrow 2 \times 10^{-4}$ ), neuron-projection morphogenesis  $1.81 \rightarrow 2.26$ , cell morphogenesis

1.72  $\rightarrow$  2.24, neuron development 1.59  $\rightarrow$  1.97, generation of neurons 1.60  $\rightarrow$  1.90, transcription by RNA polymerase II 1.73  $\rightarrow$  2.08 (Supplementary Fig. S15). The photoreception signal — weakest in the full set — becomes the single most enriched theme after the screen, and its more specific child terms (detection of light stimulus 2.5  $\rightarrow$  3.9, phototransduction 2.5  $\rightarrow$  3.4) move in the same direction, though with too few genes to reach significance. A shared-gene enrichment map of the BGS-robust set resolves the same two connected modules, neural development/morphogenesis and light response, with no third (Supplementary Fig. S16, Table S5). Because background selection can only remove diversity where genes are dense, a signal that grows as gene-dense false positives are removed is the opposite of what a BGS artefact would produce: the sweep program in *Illex illecebrosus* is a coherent sensory-and-neural one, and it is real.

**Candidate sweeps.** The Tier-2 concordant regions carry a biologically coherent set of cephalopod-orthologous genes that sit squarely within these themes (??; Supplementary Table S6): the neural/EMT transcription factor *ZEB2*, the synaptic-vesicle GTPase *Rab3*, the apelin receptor *Aplnr* (cardiovascular/vasculature signalling), the DNA-damage-response gene *MACROD2*, the phospholipid synthase *cept1*, and — at a locus the annotation had missed — a ceramide phosphoethanolamine synthase. A per-region background-selection test isolates 11 of these as high-confidence candidates in which diversity is reduced beyond the background-selection expectation, and fine-scale localisation confirms all 11 as recent sweeps by the sign of Tajima’s *D* at the diversity valley, reassigning two apparent gene-desert signals to transposable-element regions (flagged lower confidence) and one candidate’s target to a neighbouring gene. The single most distinctive autosomal candidate is a **cephalopod-lineage-specific gene under a hard sweep** on chromosome 16 — a tandem-exon transcript with no functional annotation whose translation matches an uncharacterised protein family in the bobtail squid *Euprymna* ( $E = 2 \times 10^{-53}$ ) — the kind of lineage-specific novelty that cephalopod genomes are known to generate (??). There is no overlap between the sweep candidates and the MK-adaptive genes, as expected for their different timescales.

**The Z chromosome.** Because males are Z-diploid and females Z-haploid, the Z was scanned separately in the 330 confident ZZ males, using a model retrained at the matched sample size (the classifier’s features are sample-size dependent) and a formal adequacy gate for the Z’s reduced effective size; the male-only screen was validated against the 289 haploid females, whose per-window diversity tracks the males’ at  $r = 0.996$ . Of the four Z Tier-1 calls (three hard, one soft; Supplementary Fig. S18), three credible, gene-localised sweeps survive fine-scale triage, all confirmed as conserved cephalopod genes by direct homology: **Pasilla/Nova-1** (a neuronal alternative-splicing regulator; 92% identity to *Octopus*), **Smaug/samd4a** (a germline RNA-binding translational repressor), and **Esrrg** (an estrogen-related receptor with an adjacent likely-*cis*-regulatory lncRNA; 97.5% identity to *Octopus*) — a coherent RNA-regulation-and-hormone-signalling signature on the sex chromosome that echoes the neural theme of the autosomes. The *Amnionless*/"Zfest" sex-determination locus falls just outside the swept valley and shows only purifying selection: a linked passenger, not the target.

### 3 Discussion

*Illex illecebrosus* emerges as a large- $N_e$ , expansion-dominated genome carrying a single dramatic axis of structure — a balancing-selected chromosome-2 supergene — against an otherwise unstructured, moderately background-selected background on which recent directional selection has acted

on a specific biology. Where the earlier survey (?) established panmixia for management, our contribution is to find the inversion beneath it, to explain it, and to look past it.

**The inversion is a datable, declining, balancing-selected supergene.** Most inversions whose evolutionary dynamics are understood are maintained by local adaptation with migration (???); the *Illex illecebrosus* inversion cannot be, because there is no geography to adapt to — arrangement frequency is non-clinal and geographic  $F_{ST}$  is zero everywhere. It must instead be held by balancing selection, and the data constrain *how* it has been held with unusual precision. The excess diversity of the rare derived arrangement forces a history in which BB was once common; two mutation-rate-free arguments and a barrier-aware coalescent fit converge on an ~850 ky-old polymorphism that plateaued near 0.74 and has been actively driven down to 0.37 over the last ~50–100 ky. This is a qualitatively different object from the classic *Drosophila* inversions, whose frequencies track clines and seasons (??), and from the human 17q21 inversion, whose signature is a recent rise under positive selection (?). It resembles more the mimicry supergene of *Heliconius numata*, where an inverted arrangement carries a recessive deleterious load that generates associative overdominance and caps its frequency (?). Associative overdominance is a natural candidate here: theory shows it emerges precisely in large, non-recombining blocks once recessive load accumulates (???), and the clustered coding divergence we document — 19 exonic fixed differences in nine genes, in a block whose 45 annotated genes show no functional enrichment — is the raw material of such a load. But a two-phase history of plateau followed by decline is also what selection toward a shifting optimum can produce (?); fluctuating selection is demonstrably strong in wild populations (??), and a shelf spawner whose paralarvae are advected by the Gulf Stream is a plausible target of ~100 ky climate cycles. The data constrain the trajectory, not the mechanism. What they do establish is that the arrangement itself, not any single gene within it, is the unit of selection: the block is gene-poor, functionally unremarkable, differentiated as a unit, and free of sweeps, exactly as expected when recombination suppression is the trait under selection (??).

Two features of the inversion analysis are methodologically general. First, the age is carried by the polarisation-symmetric divergence between arrangements, so it survived a complete reversal of which arrangement is derived — a reversal forced on us by discovering that the reference genome is itself inverted. Reference-orientation circularity is a hazard for any inversion study that polarises from the reference allele, and outgroup-based polarisation on non-reference sites is the remedy. Second, the coalescent inside an inversion is a two-deme process with a barrier (??), and fitting it requires a simulator that enforces the barrier in the ancestral recombination graph rather than approximating the arrangements as freely recombining. msinv provides this, and the plateau-and-decline history it recovers is not accessible to methods that treat the inversion as a single locus. As the catalogue of wild inversions grows (??), joint estimation of age, trajectory and selection from per-arrangement diversity, divergence and the joint SFS offers a route to classifying them by history rather than by phenotype.

**The sweep program is neural and photoreceptive, and it is robust to background selection.** The genome-wide scan resolves into two themes. The first — neurogenesis, neuron development, and neuron-projection and cell morphogenesis — is what one might expect of a lineage whose defining evolutionary innovation is a large, centralised, cell-type-rich nervous system (??), and whose genomes are marked by regulatory reorganisation around neural genes (?). The second, photoreception, is the more surprising and the more *Illex illecebrosus*-specific. Cephalopod photoreception is not confined to the camera eye: opsins and phototransduction cascades are expressed in skin and chromatophores (??), and the visual system is highly cell-type-diverse, with optic lobes

elaborated convergently with those of vertebrates (???). *Illex illecebrosus* is a fast, visually guided predator that migrates vertically each day through a steep light gradient and seasonally across latitude (?); selection on light detection is biologically apposite. The decisive evidence that these themes are real, rather than by-products of reduced diversity at gene-dense neural loci, is their behaviour under the background-selection screen. Background selection lowers diversity where genes are dense (???); a sweep call that is really a BGS artefact is therefore *removed* by a test that demands diversity below the BGS expectation, and any enrichment riding on such calls should erode. Instead every leading term sharpened — light response  $1.9 \rightarrow 3.1$ , radiation  $1.8 \rightarrow 2.8$ , morphogenesis  $1.7\text{--}1.8 \rightarrow 2.2\text{--}2.3$  — and the weakest theme became the strongest. The sweep program is not an artefact of gene density.

We frame these as candidates rather than confirmed targets, and the framework itself is offered as a contribution. Simulation-trained per-window classifiers are increasingly standard (??), but on a strongly expanding, unphased, missing-data-rich genome they over-call because real neutral sequence is spatially more heterogeneous than tractable neutral simulations. Rather than hide this behind a threshold, we quantified it and let it dictate the framing — a stratified empirical-outlier scan, cross-method concordance, and an explicit background-selection filter — in the spirit of recent calls for inference that models the confounders it cannot remove (?). The predominance of hard over soft sweeps in the enriched set is notable because a population this large is expected to adapt mainly by soft sweeps from standing variation (?); a hard-sweep excess instead points to strong selection on new or rare variants with a small mutational target (??), in contrast to humans, where soft sweeps appear to dominate (?); the soft-sweep class is underpowered here, however, and we draw no firm conclusion about the mode of adaptation.

**Demography, sweepstakes, and what licenses the rest.** A sweepstakes-reproduction species is exactly where multiple-merger coalescents are expected to masquerade as expansion (??), and recent work on Atlantic cod argues that pervasive recurrent sweeps can themselves generate multiple-merger genealogies (?). We tested the coalescent class directly rather than assuming it: the SFS is Kingman-plus-growth, not Beta, and SFS- and LD-based  $N_e$  agree. That result is what licenses every age and selection estimate above, and it means that *Illex illecebrosus*'s enormous fecundity has not, at the genomic scale we can resolve, translated into the skewed genealogies its life history would suggest. That the inversion arose at essentially the same time as the expansion began is a coincidence worth noting: a supergene established at the onset of a  $\sim 12$ -fold demographic expansion would have been carried through that expansion at its plateau frequency, and its subsequent decline is a recent event against that backdrop.

## 4 Limitations

The callset is unphased, so no haplotype-homozygosity statistics are available; sweep detection relies on the SFS and diversity alone, which limits power against soft sweeps in particular. The simulation-to-real neutral mismatch that drives classifier over-calling is real and unresolved at the level of absolute neutral calling — our empirical-outlier framing is a principled response, not a cure — and it also defeats a within-arrangement SFS approach to the inversion. Every inversion age scales inversely with the mutation rate, and  $\mu = 3 \times 10^{-9}$  is the weakest external input; an independent calibration (e.g. a karyotyped congener such as *I. argentinus*) is the clearest route to a mutation-rate-free age. The inversion model conditions on a deterministic frequency trajectory and within-arrangement neutrality; it constrains the shape of  $p(t)$ , not the mechanism of balancing selection. The LD-based recombination map has a compressed dynamic range at chro-

mosome scale and does not resolve centromeric suppression (Supplementary Fig. S22); it is used only for its genome-wide mean and for the decoder’s dwell scaling, and the absence of a diversity–recombination relationship in these data should be read with that ceiling in mind. The corroborating footprint methods are broad, and the recombination-aware decoder is design-informed rather than simulation-calibrated. Candidate sweep genes rest on homology to distant cephalopod models and on cross-method concordance; the two enrichment themes are statements about gene sets, not about individual confirmed targets.

## 5 Methods

Full parameter values, software versions, and command-level provenance are in Supplementary Table S1 and in the project repository.

**Data.** The ingroup is all 633 *Illex illecebrosus* individuals whole-genome sequenced by ? (ENA project PRJEB101095; collected 2022–2023 across eleven NAFO divisions, every individual with coordinates), of which that study retained 540 after its own quality filters. We re-processed the raw reads from scratch: mapping to the *Illex\_F24* primary assembly (45 numbered chromosomes plus the Z) and joint variant calling (Supplementary Table S1). Genotypes are unphased and the VCF is variants-only (no invariant sites), so diversity is computed from genotype likelihoods off the BAMs rather than from called genotypes. *I. coindetii* is the divergence/MK outgroup; *I. argentinus* is a secondary comparator. An accessibility mask restricts all analyses to callable sites.

**Diversity, SFS, and demography.** Site-frequency spectra, Watterson’s  $\theta$ , per-window  $\pi$  and Tajima’s  $D$ , and per-karyotype spectra were computed with ANGSD (?) (`-doSaf/realSFS`); per-population statistics were computed per NAFO division and per chromosome (all 45 autosomes plus the Z, the latter in males only). Demographic history was inferred with Stairway Plot 2 (?), moments (?), and GONE2 (?), and validated by forward simulation reproducing the observed  $\pi$  and  $D$ . The coalescent class was tested by comparing the folded SFS against Kingman-plus-growth and Beta-coalescent expectations. Windowed  $\pi$ ,  $d_{xy}$ ,  $F_{ST}$ , and PCA used `pg_gpu` (?); per-SNP and between-karyotype  $F_{ST}$  used the Hudson estimator (?). Relatedness was screened with KING-robust (?).

**Karyotyping and the inversion.** Karyotypes were called by local PCA (?) and a Gaussian-mixture model. Arrangement polarisation used an AnchorWave (?) *I. coindetii*↔*Illex illecebrosus* whole-genome alignment restricted to non-reference-biased sites, with `est-sfs` (?) as a check. The inversion’s age and frequency trajectory were fit with `msinv` v0.3.5 (?), an ARG-based coalescent simulator that enforces cross-karyotype recombination barriers and outputs tree sequences, implementing hull-based ancestral-material tracking in the `msprime` lineage (??); it was validated against SLiM (?), `msprime` (?), and `discoal` (?). All coalescent simulations underlying the inversion age and decline inference were generated with `msinv`, and the complete chr2-inversion analysis — fitting code, simulation configuration, and every per-analysis output and figure — is housed as a dedicated *Illex illecebrosus* module within the `msinv` repository (`files/illex/`, `results/illex/`). Simulations used the fitted growth demography,  $\mu = 3 \times 10^{-9}$ , and  $r = 1.977 \times 10^{-9}$ ; statistics were computed on the differentiated body and rescaled from a 37-kb simulated inversion with length-invariance verified over a 25-fold range. Breakpoints were pinned by combining arrangement differentiation with the AnchorWave alignment; missed genes were recovered by DIAMOND `blastx` (?) against seven cephalopod proteomes, with transposable elements annotated by Earl Grey (?)

and transcripts by StringTie2 (?). Fixed differences between arrangements were defined as sites with  $|\Delta AF| \geq 0.9$  between AA ( $n = 254$ ) and BB ( $n = 95$ ) homozygotes; the gene-ontology test of inversion genes used Fisher’s exact test against the genome-wide annotated-gene background in all three ontologies, with a permutation null of 500 random gene sets of equal size.

**Recombination map.** Per-sex recombination maps were built with ReLERNN (?) (SIMULATE→TRAIN→PR dropping individuals with no calls on a chromosome and never forcing diploid genotype calls.

**Selective-sweep scan.** The classifier was diploS/HIC (?) (five classes, 1.1 Mb windows of eleven 100 kb sub-windows, twelve diploid statistics per sub-window), trained on SLiM 5.2 forward simulations (?) (recapitated with msprime; ??) and pure-msprime neutral simulations under the fitted growth demography, at the empirical sample size and with realistic structured missingness. The model was trained on the same unphased feature extractor (**fvecVcf**) used to scan, on the full spectrum (no MAF filter). It was used as a stratified empirical-outlier detector (score  $p_{\text{hard}} + p_{\text{soft}}$  ranked within callable-fraction  $\times$  coding-density strata), corroborated by RAI SD (?) and SweepFinder2 (?). The per-window classifications were spatially resolved into Tier-1 calls with a recombination-aware hidden Markov model (neutral / linked / sweep-centre states; emissions are the prior-corrected collapsed class posteriors; dwell lengths set from the  $\sim 400$  kb sweep footprint scaled by the ReLERNN sex-averaged map, with a constant-rate fallback on chromosomes 2 and 42 and the Z). A simulation calibration of the decoder was attempted but proved infeasible: at  $N_e$ -scale recombination the recapitated ancestral recombination graphs carry  $\sim 3.4 \times 10^5$  marginal trees per 2.5 Mb, making tree-sequence genotype ascertainment for a training scan prohibitively slow ( $> 2.7$  h per segment); the dwell parameters are therefore design-informed and validated post hoc by the 89%/2.9% Tier-1–Tier-2 concordance (Supplementary Fig. S13). The Z chromosome was scanned in males only with a model retrained at  $n = 330$  and passed a comparative feature-adequacy gate, then validated against the haploid females. Candidate genes were annotated with EnTAP and screened by DIAMOND against cephalopod proteomes. Gene-ontology enrichment of Tier-1 genes used Fisher’s exact test against the annotated-gene background on the scanned chromosomes with Benjamini–Hochberg FDR (?); the background-selection screen retained calls whose local  $\pi$  fell below the expectation from flanking coding density ( $\hat{\pi} = 0.01059 - 0.16547 \cdot f_{\text{CDS}}$ ; standardised residual  $\leq -0.3$ ).

**McDonald–Kreitman.** MK tests used mkado (?) against the *I. coindetii* outgroup over 20,999 genes, with degeneracy annotated by degenotate (?).

## Data and code availability

The manuscript, all figures and tables, their generating scripts, and editable table exports are in the manuscript repository ([https://github.com/stsmall/Illex\\_popgen](https://github.com/stsmall/Illex_popgen)); a section-by-section index of every figure and table source file is provided there as FIGURES\_AND\_TABLES\_INDEX.md. The coalescent simulations for the inversion analysis (??) were generated with msinv v0.3.5, a general ARG-based inversion-coalescent simulator (<https://github.com/stsmall/msinv>, MIT); this study’s complete *Illex illecebrosus*-specific inversion analysis — fitting code, simulation configuration, tabulated outputs, and the inversion figures — is contained within that repository under files/illex/ and results/illex/.

Table 1: **Sample and whole-genome summary.** Diversity statistics are genome-wide from genotype likelihoods; karyotype counts and the inverted-arrangement frequency are for chromosome 2.

| Quantity                                | Value                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Species / callset                       | <i>Illex illecebrosus</i> ; ? whole-genome            |
| Individuals (karyotyped)                | 633                                                   |
| Sex (chrZ coverage)                     | 342 ZZ males / 291 ZO females                         |
| Sampling                                | 11 NAFO divisions, $\sim 37\text{--}50^\circ\text{N}$ |
| Geographic structure                    | $F_{ST} \approx 0$ (none outside chr2)                |
| Genome-wide $\pi$                       | 0.0093                                                |
| Genome-wide Tajima's $D$                | $-2.07$ ( $-2.09$ in 50 kb windows)                   |
| chr2 karyotypes (AA/AB/BB)              | 254 / 284 / 95                                        |
| Inverted (BB) frequency                 | 0.374 (0.29–0.46 across divisions, non-clinal)        |
| Karyotype $F_{ST}(\text{AA},\text{BB})$ | 0.365                                                 |

Table 2: **The chromosome-2 inversion** (corrected polarisation: I = BB inverted/derived, S = AA ancestral/standard).

| Quantity                                | Value                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Location (differentiated body)          | chr2:60.54–79.50 Mb ( $\sim 18.96$ Mb)                                                     |
| Karyotypes (AA/AB/BB)                   | 254 / 284 / 95 (95.3% confident)                                                           |
| Inverted (BB) frequency $p$             | 0.374                                                                                      |
| Historical peak frequency               | $\sim 0.74$                                                                                |
| Karyotype $F_{ST}(\text{AA},\text{BB})$ | 0.365 (geographic $F_{ST} \approx 0$ )                                                     |
| $\pi_I/\pi_S$ (I=BB)                    | $1.356 \pm 0.048$                                                                          |
| $d_{xy}/\pi_I$                          | $1.385 \pm 0.021$                                                                          |
| Coalescent age $t_{inv}$                | $\sim 850$ ky ( $\propto 1/\mu$ , $\mu = 3 \times 10^{-9}$ )                               |
| Decline                                 | $0.74 \rightarrow 0.374$ over $\sim 50\text{--}100$ ky, ending $\gtrsim 50\text{--}100$ ka |
| Selection on decline                    | $N_e s \sim 10^2\text{--}10^3$ ( $s \approx 1.5 \times 10^{-4}$ )                          |
| Gene content                            | 89 gene models, 45 annotated; no GO enrichment ( $p = 0.51$ )                              |
| Fixed differences (AA vs BB)            | 3,513; 19 exonic, in 9 genes                                                               |

## Acknowledgements

[TODO: funding, sequencing, sample collection, computing.]

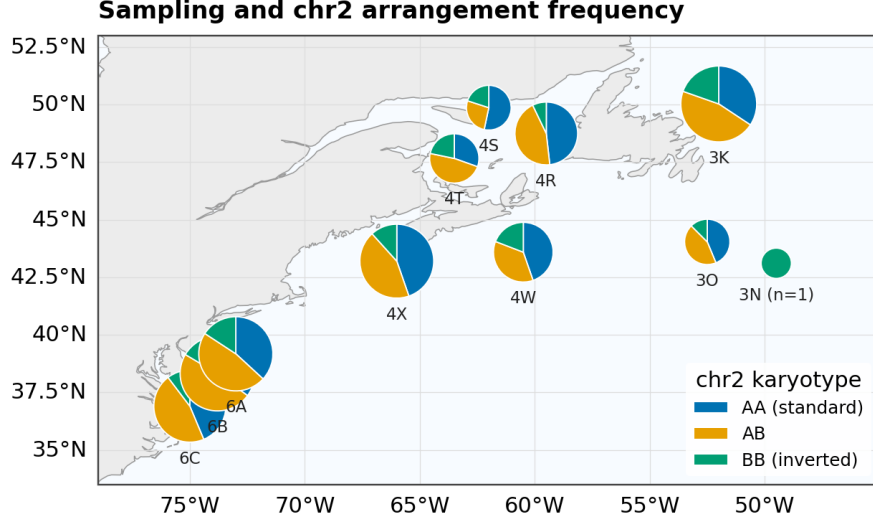


Figure 1: **Sampling and chromosome-2 arrangement frequency.** *Illex illecebrosus* sampled across eleven NAFO divisions ( $\sim 37\text{--}50^\circ\text{N}$ ); pies show the AA/AB/BB karyotype composition at each division (sized by  $N$ ). The inverted (BB) frequency is non-clinal (0.29–0.46 across latitude), consistent with geographic  $F_{ST} \approx 0$  — the inversion is not locally adaptive.

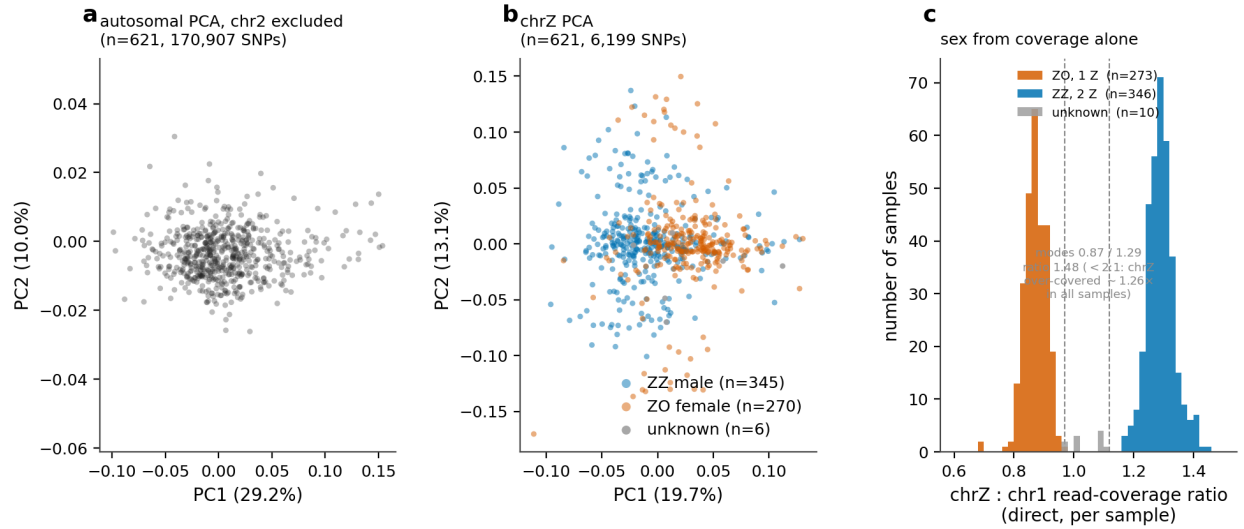
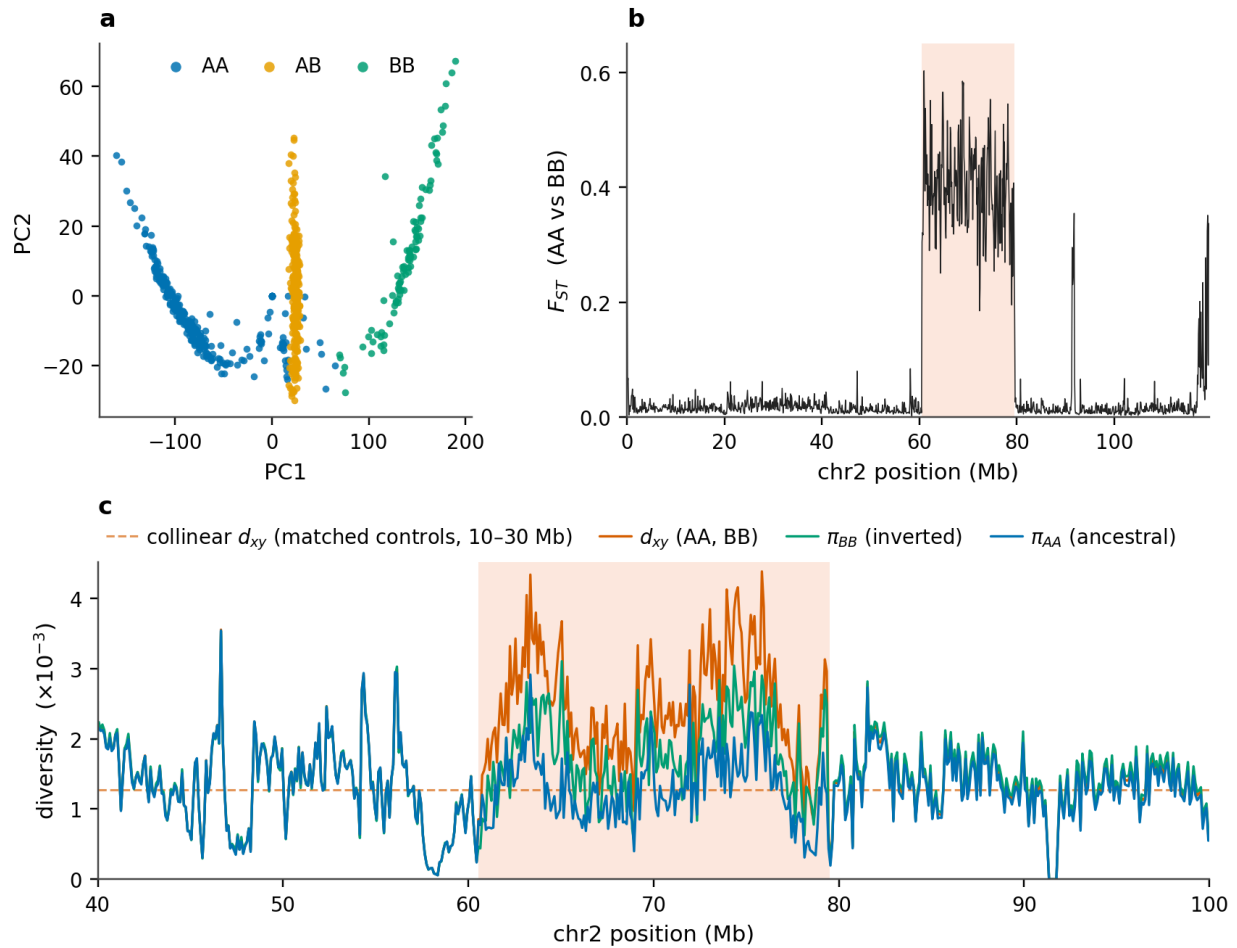


Figure 2: **No population structure outside chr2, and the sex assignment** (consistent with the range-wide panmixia of ?). **(a)** Genome-wide autosomal PCA with chr2 excluded — a single undifferentiated cloud. **(b)** chrZ PCA (mild male/female separation). **(c)** chrZ:chr1 read-coverage ratio by individual: ZZ males at  $\sim 1.0$  (two Z copies), ZO females near the single-copy expectation (there is no W); individuals in the ambiguous band are left unassigned. 342 males / 291 females.



**Figure 3: The chromosome-2 inversion.** (a) chr2 PCA resolves three karyotype clusters (AA/AB/BB). (b)  $F_{ST}$  between arrangements along chr2 — the inversion (60.54–79.50 Mb, shaded) is the only differentiated region (median  $F_{ST}$  = 0.37 vs 0.01 collinear; whole-chromosome view in Supplementary Fig. S20). (c) Per-arrangement diversity across the inversion (shaded) and 20 Mb of collinear sequence on either side: inside the breakpoints the derived, inverted BB arrangement is *more* diverse than the ancestral AA ( $\pi_I/\pi_S$  = 1.36) despite its lower frequency, and  $d_{xy}$  exceeds both — the signature of an old, formerly common polymorphism; outside them the three curves collapse onto one another at the collinear  $d_{xy}$  (dashed), as expected where the arrangements recombine freely.

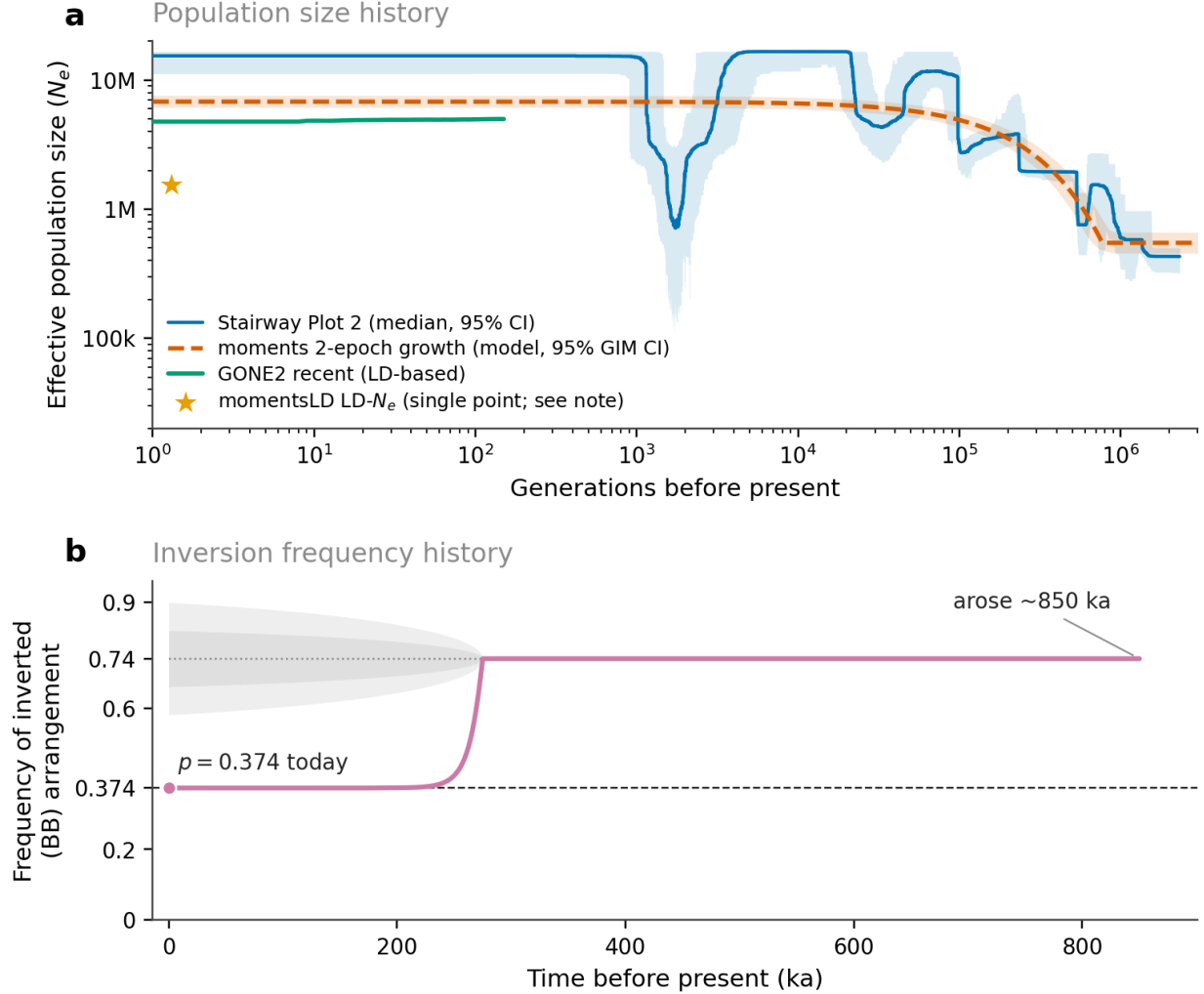


Figure 4: **Demographic history and the inversion's frequency history.** (a) Effective population size over time: Stairway Plot 2 (median  $\pm 95\%$  CI), the moments 2-epoch growth model with its Godambe (GIM) 95% parameter-CI envelope (expansion  $12.4 \times \pm 9\%$ ,  $T \approx 770$  ky  $\pm 16\%$ ), GONE2 for the recent past, and a single momentsLD LD- $N_e$  point (rate-corrected; only the contemporary point is shown because its time-varying fit is non-identifiable). (b) Inversion trajectory fit with the barrier-aware coalescent simulator msinv: the derived (BB) arrangement arose ~850 ka — coincident with the onset of expansion in (a) — was held near  $p \approx 0.74$ , and declined to 0.374; the neutral-drift envelope is shown for comparison.  $\Delta\chi^2$  profiles locating the end and duration of the decline are in Supplementary Fig. S14; the fall was recent and fast, excluding neutral drift-out.

Table 3: **Demographic model** (moments, folded SFS; validated by forward simulation).

| Parameter                 | Value                                         |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Ancestral $N_e$ (N_REF)   | 547,928                                       |
| Present $N_e$ (N0)        | 6,808,096                                     |
| Growth duration (T_GROW)  | 769,519 generations                           |
| Fold expansion            | $\sim 12\times$                               |
| Genome-wide $\pi$         | 0.0093                                        |
| Genome-wide Tajima's $D$  | $\approx -2$ (nearly all windows)             |
| Mutation rate $\mu$       | $3 \times 10^{-9}$ / bp / generation          |
| Recombination (autosomal) | $\sim 0.21\text{--}0.24$ cM/Mb (sex-averaged) |

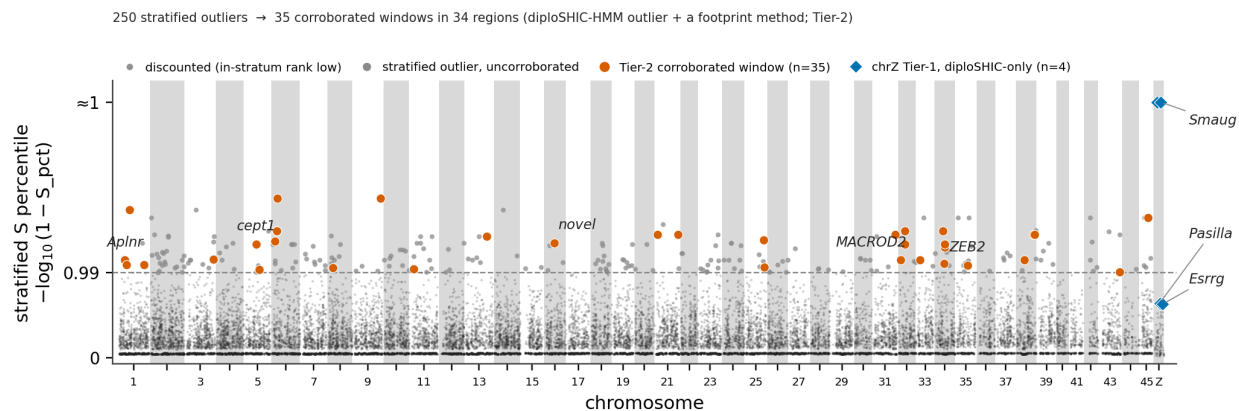


Figure 5: **The genome-wide selective-sweep scan.** Sweep signal across the genome (chromosomes concatenated). The classifier reads the genome as pervasively *linked*-selected ( $\sim 91\%$  linked-hard/soft; neutral  $\sim 1\%$ ; true hard/soft only a few percent), so raw diploS/HIC calls are filtered by cross-method concordance (a diploS/HIC-HMM outlier plus RAiSD or SweepFinder2) and a background-selection test; the corroborated, background-selection-robust candidates (35 windows across 34 regions; highlighted) stand out above the discounted background, with key genes labelled. Chromosome-Z Tier-1 calls (diamonds; *Pasilla*, *Smaug*, *Esrrg* labelled) are male-based and diploS/HIC-only — the footprint methods do not cover the Z — so they cannot enter the concordance filter. Chromosome 2 carries no concordant sweep. The full scan pipeline is shown in Supplementary Fig. S8.

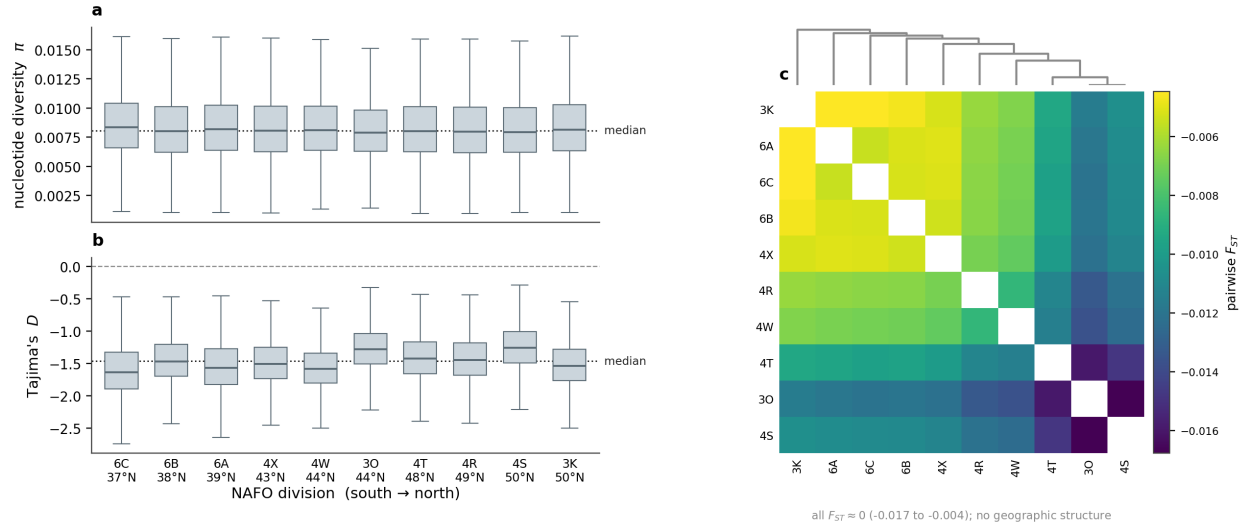


Figure 6: **Diversity is uniform and there is no geographic structure.** (a) Nucleotide diversity  $\pi$  and (b) Tajima's  $D$  per NAFO division (ten of the eleven sampled divisions; 3N, with a single individual, cannot support per-population estimates), ordered south→north — both are flat across latitude (no cline), and  $D$  is negative in every population, the signature of strong expansion. (c) Pairwise  $F_{ST}$  among divisions as a clustered heatmap with dendrogram: every value is  $\approx 0$  ( $-0.017$  to  $-0.004$ ) and the clustering follows sample size, not geography — no population structure. ( $\pi/D$  estimated by ANGSD genotype likelihoods over all 45 autosomes plus the Z, large divisions subsampled to  $n = 25$ ;  $F_{ST}$  genome-wide by pg\_gpu. Per-chromosome distributions: Supplementary Fig. S9.)

Table 4: **High-confidence selective-sweep candidates**, grouped by biological function and ordered by chromosome, including the Z-chromosome set. Autosomal rows are the 11 background-selection-robust candidates (of 34 concordant regions); Z rows (marked) are the fine-scale-confirmed sweeps from the males-only scan. Genes are cephalopod orthologs. Class: hard/soft sweep. Full machine-readable tables: Supplementary Table S6.

| Location                                        | Gene / feature                                     | Class    |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <i>Neural, RNA-regulation &amp; development</i> |                                                    |          |
| chr35:39.0 Mb                                   | <i>ZEB2</i> (neural/EMT transcription factor)      | hard     |
| Z:20.8 Mb                                       | <i>Pasilla</i> /Nova-1 (splicing regulator)        | hard (Z) |
| Z:23.6 Mb                                       | <i>Smaug</i> /samd4a (translational repressor)     | hard (Z) |
| <i>Cardiovascular</i>                           |                                                    |          |
| chr1:20.3 Mb                                    | <i>Aplnr</i> (apelin receptor)                     | hard     |
| <i>Genome-maintenance &amp; stress</i>          |                                                    |          |
| chr32:9.3 Mb                                    | <i>MACROD2</i> (DNA-damage response)               | soft     |
| <i>Membrane &amp; lipid</i>                     |                                                    |          |
| chr5:38.0 Mb                                    | <i>cept1</i> (phospholipid synthesis)              | hard     |
| chr1:85.5 Mb                                    | ceramide phosphoethanolamine synthase <sup>†</sup> | hard     |
| <i>Metabolism</i>                               |                                                    |          |
| chr25:65.0 Mb                                   | <i>GALT</i> <sup>†</sup>                           | soft     |
| <i>ECM &amp; adhesion</i>                       |                                                    |          |
| chr33:9.0 Mb                                    | <i>Tinagl1</i>                                     | hard     |
| <i>Signalling</i>                               |                                                    |          |
| chr32:24.1 Mb                                   | GPCR cluster                                       | hard     |
| Z:30.7 Mb                                       | <i>Esrrg</i> (estrogen-related receptor)           | soft (Z) |
| <i>Cephalopod-specific novelty</i>              |                                                    |          |
| chr16:35.3 Mb                                   | uncharacterised ( <i>Euprymna</i> family)          | hard     |
| <i>Lower confidence (TE-dense)</i>              |                                                    |          |
| chr1:35.9 Mb                                    | transposable element <sup>‡</sup>                  | hard     |
| chr11:10.8 Mb                                   | transposable element <sup>‡</sup>                  | hard     |

<sup>†</sup> target reassigned by fine-scale localisation (annotation-recovered gene). <sup>‡</sup> TE-dense region; deep- $\pi$ /negative- $D$  may be a TE-insertion sweep or a repeat artifact.

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